



Don't want Chinese phones?

These are the best alternatives to Chinese made smartphones, with recommendations for every budget. <https://digit.in/jul20-99>



WatchOS 7 and tvOS 14

All the new features coming to Apple watches and the Apple TV announced at WWDC 2020. <https://digit.in/jul20-100>

OnePlus 8 Pro

Slickest Android of 2020

While there have been a handful of Snapdragon 865-powered smartphones, the OnePlus 8 Pro is easily the most anticipated one. Let us see if the device lives up to the hype.

Design and display

The OnePlus 8 Pro looks and feels like the premium flagship it claims to be. The phone is IP68 rated but it doesn't cover water damage under warranty. However, it can easily survive a tumble in the sink or heavy rain. OnePlus has also included another much-desired feature - wireless charging. That too at an unheard of 30W speed, which requires the Warp 30 Wireless Charger sold separately. We didn't get the chance to test it out yet. The variant we received was the Glacier Green colour, and on this, the company has given a matte finish which reminds us of the Pearl White variant of the OnePlus 6. It's much slimmer and lighter than before now that the pop-up mechanism is replaced by a punch-hole camera on the display.

The 6.78-inch QHD+ AMOLED display covers 90% of the body with very thin bezels on the top and bottom edge. On the side, the screen curves sharper than before and this actually hinders the display experience. There's significant discolouration around the edges and that becomes apparent in the camera app, or when you're watching a movie. Also the peak brightness only hit 786 lux in our light meter, which is far lower than what we saw on the regular OnePlus 8 and even on the Mi 10.

Camera

The OnePlus 8 Pro features not one, but two 48MP cameras this time in a quad-camera stack. There's a primary 48MP Sony IMX689 sensor, a 48MP, an 8MP telephoto lens with 3X hybrid



zoom and a colour filter lens which was defunct in our review unit owing to the controversies around how it can see through plastic, and even clothes.

Among all other OnePlus cameras we have tested over the years, the primary 48 MP lens gets the closest to beating the premium flagships in terms of the details and sharpness it produces when the light is optimum. Tricky situations don't perturb the camera all that much either. The dynamic range is also quite good with photos balancing out the highlights and shadows to appear quite natural. What did irk us was a tendency for the camera to highlight blue tones a lot more in the photos, and in some cases, noisy details, especially for indoor shots. The camera also has a smaller plane of focus which became apparent when we were trying to take photos of our culinary adventures.

Videos from the primary 48MP camera aren't all that good. It takes horribly long to focus on a subject up close and even when you do, it will drop the focus mid-way into the shoot and never recover until you start all over again.

With the OnePlus 8 Pro, you'll get the best results from this ultrawide lens than from any other Android flagship right now. The 48 MP camera also delivers the best dynamic range in the wide-angle shots, among its peers and this is certainly a welcome addition.

Performance

In benchmarking tests, we were surprised to see every single flagship Android phone we've tested this year beat the OnePlus 8 Pro, although, the difference is perfectly within the margin of variance we expect in scores. Still, over the OnePlus 7 Pro last year, we saw around 15-18% boost in performance, which is good.

What does improve the experience is the 120Hz refresh rate on the phone. It feels far too smooth when compared against last year's OnePlus 7 Pro. However, there are chinks in this otherwise powerful armour. The OnePlus 8 Pro kept freezing for a few seconds every time our Instagram Stories

feed would encounter a video, and sometimes even when we scrolled down a recipe online. Unfreezing required a quick lock-unlock, but the issue persists even as of writing the review. Nevertheless, we've reached out to OnePlus about it, and they have acknowledged it. So safe to say, a patch is incoming. The phone also heated up quite fast when used outdoors. Thankfully, there's no sign of overheating while gaming.

Bottomline

The OnePlus 8 Pro ticks all the boxes for a premium device this time, and if not for inconsistent camera performance, it would have been at par with the Samsung and Apple flagships. The OnePlus 8 works just as well sans the wireless charging, 120Hz at QHD+ display, and a high-res wide-angle camera.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

Performance: Qualcomm Snapdragon 865 | Graphics: Adreno 650 | Processor: Octa-core (2.84 GHz, Single core, Kryo 585 + 2.42 GHz, Tri core, Kryo 585 + 1.8 GHz, Quad-core, Kryo 585) | Storage: 128 GB | RAM: 8 GB | Camera: 48+48+8+5 MP | Front Camera: 16 MP | Battery: 4510 mAh | Display: 6.78" | Fingerprint Sensor Position: On-screen | Fingerprint Sensor Type: Optical | Operating System: Android v10 | Custom UI: Oxygen OS

CONTACT

OnePlus | Phone: 18001028411 | Email: Web form | Website: <https://www.oneplus.in/>